Saint John the Baptist Ukrainian Catholic Church

60 North Jefferson Road
Whippany, New Jersey, 07981
(973) 887 – 3616
Website: sjukrcc.com
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Rev. Stepan Bilyk—Pastor

BULLETIN

Liturgical Schedule. Sunday, March 15, 2026.

Readings: Heb 6:13-20 Mk 9:17-31 Tone 7.

Saturday, March 14: Ven. Benedict of Nursia. Преподобного Венедикта.

9:00 A.M. †За померлих з наших родин .(Сорокоусти)
5:00 P.M. For all parishioners. (Eng.)

Sunday, March 15: 4-th Sunday of Great Fast. 4-та Неділя Великого Посту.
8:30 A.M Ганна Телепко (З Днем Народження!) - Родина.
Андрій, Світлана, Володимир, Любомир і всієї родина—Родина Вовк. (Ukr).
10:00 A.M. За перемогу у війні і мир в Україні. (Ukr/Eng).

Monday, March 16: Martyr Sabinua & Papas.
No service.

Tuesday, March 17: Ven. Alexius, Man of God.
7:00 P.M. Stations of the Cross. Хресна Дорога.

Wednesday, March 18: Hier. Cyril of Jerusalem.

7:00 P.M. Liturgy of Presanctified Gifts. Літургія Передшеосвячених Дарів.

Thursday, March 19: Martyrs Chrysanthus & Daria.
No service.

Friday, March 20: Ven. Martyrs of Sabbas Monastery.

6:00 P.M. Confession. Сповідь.
7:00 P.M. †За померлих з наших родин .(Сорокоусти) .

†Ева Ленчур (40-ий День) - Родина Ленчур.

Saturday, March 21: Conf. James of Catania.

8:00 A.M. Confession. Сповідь.
9:00 A.M. Divine Liturgy for health and blessing of all our parishioners.

4:00 P.M. Confession. Сповідь.
5:00 P.M. For all parishioners. (Eng.)

Sunday, March 22: 5th Sunday of the Great Fast. 5-та Неділя Великого Посту.
7:45 A.M. Confession. Сповідь.
8:30 A.M †Марія. Михайло. Микола—Родина Телепко. (Ukr).
10:00 A.M. За перемогу у війні і мир в Україні. (Ukr/Eng).

Everyone is invited to join our parish prayer group. Where two or three, many, gather in communal prayer we experience God's presence in more intimate and deeper way. The prayer group gathers for payer at 10 A.M. every Tuesday of the week. Everyone is welcomed, men and women. Now days life needs support, help, prayer, and with friends together is the best and most powerful way to remain strong in any circumstances of life. Please contact Fr. Stepan for more information at 973-906-3581.

О. Степан радо відвідає з Святими Тайнами хворих, немічних, та старших осіб, які не є взмозі з різних причин прийти до церкви, до прикладу можуть бути є в лікарнях, домах з доглядом, чи в себе вдома. Просимо подзвонити на телефони: 973-887-3616 і повідомити коли є добре відвідати ваших рідних.

Father Stepan will be more than happy to visit any sick or elderly parishioners in hospitals, nursing homes, hospices, etc., or shut-ins at home who are unable to attend church for whatever reason. Please contact him at 973-887-3616, and he will gladly visit them with Holy Communion.

This year the **LENTEN MISSION** will be offered by Fr. Volodymy Radko on Friday March 20, Saturday March 21, and Sunday March 22, 2026. March 20th, at 6 p.m. confessions, at 7 p.m. "Sorokousty" followed by spiritual teaching. Saturday at 8 a.m. confession, at 9 a.m. Divine Liturgy followed by spiritual teaching, 4 p.m. confession, 5 p.m. Divine Liturgy followed by spiritual teaching. Sunday at 8 a.m. confession. Fr. Volodymyr will hear confessions and preach during both Sunday Divine Liturgies. He is available for a personal-private meeting if requested.

Цьогорічна **ВЕЛИКОПОСНА МІСІЯ** відбудеться під проводом о. Володимира Радька в п*ятницю, суботу і неділю, 20, 21 і 22 березня, 2026. Сповідь розпочнеться в 6-год вечора в п*ятницю, в 7-год Сорокоусти і духовна наука. В суботу в 8-год зранку сповідь, в 9-год Божественна Літурґія і духовна наука. По обіді в 4-год сповідь, Божественна Літургія в 5-год і духовна наука. Просимо приготовитись і прийти до сповіді в ці дні. Якщо є потреба, о. Володимир може приватно зустрітись з вами для розмови.

Пошукуємо жінку опікуватися Мамою в суботу і неділю, з нічлігом, раз на місяць, околиця Випані.
" Seeking woman to care for our Senior Mother , one weekend a month , Sat midday to Sun midday , with overnight stay. Must speak Ukrainian . Must be in Whippany area"

Платня за домовленням - Pay per mutual agreement .
Please call 203 961-3299 and leave detailed
message with name , phone #

.
If you know of anyone needing a nanny for this summer full time, please call 862-324-6998.
Experienced young woman will help you with your child/children.

Saint John the Baptist Ukrainian Catholic Church

60 North Jefferson Road.

Whippany, NJ 07981

Lazarus Saturday, March 28

5:00 p.m. Divine Liturgy (Eng)

Flowery (Palm) Sunday, March 29

8:30 a.m. Divine Liturgy (Ukr)

10:00 a.m. Divine Liturgy (Ukr/Eng)

Holy Monday, March 30

7:00 P.M. Meditations on the Way of the Cross

Holy Tuesday, March 31

8:00 a.m. Liturgy of the Presanctified Gifts

7:00 P.M. - Akafist to the Passion of Christ

Holy Wednesday, April 01

8:00 a.m. Liturgy of the Presanctified Gifts Anointing of the Sick

7:00 P.M. - Service of the Anointing of the Sick

Holy and Great Thursday, April 02

7:00 p.m. Matins with the Reading of the Twelve Gospels (Ukr/Eng)

Good Friday, April 03 ***(Strict Fast: no meat or dairy products)***

8:00 a.m. Royal Hours

5:00 p.m. Vespers with with procession of the Plaschanitsa/Shroud

8:00 p.m. Jerusalem Matins

Holy Saturday, April 04 ***(Fast Day – No Meat)***

9:00 A.M. – Confessions.

4:00 P.M. - Blessing of Easter Food//Hahilky

5:30 P.M. - Blessing of Easter Food

6:30 P.M. – Nadhrobne (Service at the Tomb) and Divine Liturgy (Eng)

Sunday of the Resurrection (Easter), April 05

8:00 A.M. - Resurrection Matins

8:30 A.M. - Divine Liturgy (Ukr)

11:00 A.M. - Divine Liturgy (Ukr/Eng)

Bright Monday, April 06

7:00 p.m. Divine Liturgy

Bright Tuesday, April 07

9:00 a.m. Divine Liturgy

Venerable John Climacus of Sinai, Author of “the Ladder”

Saint John of the Ladder is honored by Holy Church as a great ascetic and author of the renowned spiritual book called THE LADDER, from which he is also called “of the Ladder” (Climacus).

There is almost no information about Saint John’s origins. One tradition suggests that he was born in Constantinople around the year 570 and was the son of Saints Xenophon and Maria (January 26).

John went to Sinai when he was sixteen, submitting to Abba Martyrius as his instructor and guide. After four years, Saint John was tonsured as a monk. Abba Strategios, who was present at Saint John’s tonsure, predicted that he would become a great luminary in the Church of Christ.

For nineteen years Saint John progressed in monasticism in obedience to his spiritual Father. After the death of Abba Martyrius, Saint John embarked on a solitary life, settling in a wild place called Thola, where he spent forty years laboring in silence, fasting, prayer, and tears of penitence.

It is not by chance that in THE LADDER Saint John speaks about tears of repentance: “Just as fire burns and destroys the wood, so pure tears wash away every impurity, both external and internal.” His holy prayer was strong and efficacious, as may be seen from an example from the life of the God-pleasing saint.

Saint John had a disciple named Moses. Once, the saint ordered his disciple to bring dung to fertilize the vegetable garden. When he had fulfilled obedience, Moses lay down to rest under the shade of a large rock, because of the scorching heat of summer. Saint John was in his cell in a light sleep. Suddenly, a man of remarkable appearance appeared to him and awakened the holy ascetic, reproaching him, “John, why do you sleep so heedlessly, when Moses is in danger?”

Saint John immediately woke up and began to pray for his disciple. When Moses returned in the evening, Saint John asked whether any sort of misfortune had befallen him.

The monk replied, “A large rock would have fallen on me as I slept beneath it at noon, but I left that place because I thought I heard you calling me.” Saint John did not tell his disciple of his vision but gave thanks to God.

Saint John ate the food, which is permitted by the monastic rule, but only in moderation. He did not sleep very much, only enough to keep up his strength, so that he would not ruin his mind by unceasing vigil. “I do not fast excessively,” he said of himself, “nor do I give myself over to intense all-night vigil, nor lay upon the ground, but I restrain myself..., and the Lord soon saved me.”

The following example of Saint John’s humility is noteworthy. Gifted with discernment, and attaining wisdom through spiritual experience, he lovingly received all who came to him and guided them to salvation. One day some envious monks reproached him for being too talkative, and so Saint John kept silence for a whole year. The monks realized their error, and they went to the ascetic and begged him not to deprive them of the spiritual profit of his conversation.

Concealing his ascetic deeds from others, Saint John sometimes withdrew into a cave, but reports of his holiness spread far beyond the vicinity. Visitors from all walks of life came to him, desiring to hear his words of edification and salvation. After forty years of solitary asceticism, he was chosen as igumen of Sinai when he was seventy-five. Saint John governed the holy monastery for four years. Toward the end of his life, the Lord granted him the gifts of clairvoyance and wonderworking.

At the request of Saint John, igumen of the Raithu monastery (Commemorated on Cheesefare Saturday), he wrote the incomparable LADDER, a book of instruction for monks who wished to attain spiritual perfection.

Knowing of the wisdom and spiritual gifts of Saint John of Sinai, the igumen of Raithu requested him to write down whatever was necessary for the salvation of those in the monastic life. Such a book would be "a ladder fixed on the earth" (Gen. 28:12), leading people to the gates of Heaven.

Saint John felt that such a task was beyond his ability, yet out of obedience he fulfilled the request. The saint called his work THE LADDER, for the book is "a fixed ladder leading from earthly things to the Holy of Holies...." The thirty steps of spiritual perfection correspond to the thirty years of the Lord's age. When we have completed these thirty steps, we will find ourselves with the righteous and will not stumble. THE LADDER begins with renunciation of the world, and ends with God, Who is love (1 John 4:8).

The twenty-second step of THE LADDER deals with various forms of vainglory. Saint John writes: "When I fast, I am vainglorious; and when I permit myself food to conceal my fasting from others I am again vainglorious about my prudence. When I dress in fine clothing, I am vanquished by vanity, and if I put on drab clothing, again I am overcome by vanity. If I speak, vainglory defeats me. If I wish to keep silence, I am again given over to it. Wherever this thorn comes up, it stands with its points upright.

A vain person seems to honor God but strives to please men rather than God.

People of lofty spirit bear insult placidly and willingly, but only the holy and righteous may hear praise without harm.

When you hear that your neighbor or friend has slandered you behind your back, or even to your face, praise and love him.

It is not the one who reproaches himself who shows humility, for who will not put up with himself? It is the one who is slandered by another yet continues to show love for him.

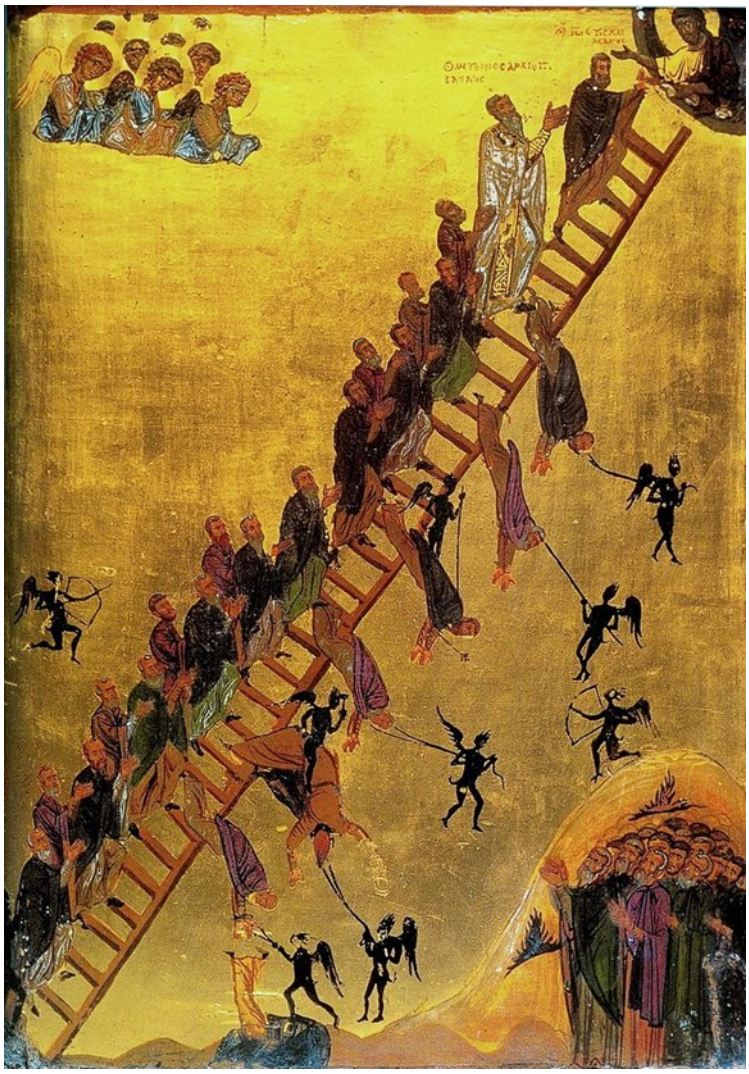
Whoever is proud of his natural gifts, intelligence, learning, skill in reading, clear enunciation, and other similar qualities, which are acquired without much labor, will never obtain supernatural gifts. Whoever is not faithful in small things (Luke 16:10), is also unfaithful in large things, and is vainglorious.

It often happens that God humbles the vainglorious, sending a sudden misfortune. If prayer does not destroy a proud thought, we bring to mind the departure of the soul from this life. And if this does not help, let us fear the shame which follows dishonor. "For whoever humbles himself shall be exalted, and whoever exalts himself shall be humbled" (Luke 14:11). When those who praise us, or rather seduce us, start to praise us, let us recall our many sins, then we shall find that we are not worthy of what they say or do to honor us."

In THE LADDER Saint John describes the ascent toward spiritual perfection, which is essential for anyone who wishes to save his soul. It is a written account of his thoughts, based on the collected wisdom of many wise ascetics, and on his own spiritual experience. The book is a great help on the path to truth and virtue.

The steps of THE LADDER proceed gradually from strength to strength on the path of perfection. The summit is not reached suddenly, but gradually, as the Savior says: "The Kingdom of Heaven suffers violence, and the violent take it by force" (Mt.11:12).

Saint John is also commemorated on the fourth Sunday of Great Lent.



15 березня Церква вшановує пам'ять святого преподобного отця нашого Йоана Ліствичника.

Життя святого преподобного отця нашого Йоана Ліствичника

Святий Йоан народився в Палестині близько 525 р. Ще юнаком він подався до лаври на горі Синай, монахи якої дивували всіх надзвичайною суворістю життя. Тут він подвизався впродовж 19 років як учень богоугодного монаха Мартирія і досяг такої святости, що багато святих пустинників, навчені Божим Духом, провістили, що він стане ігуменом цієї лаври.

Після смерти Мартирія святий Йоан провадив життя затворника в місцевості, що звалася Тола, і прожив тут в молитвах 40 років. Бог дав йому дар сліз, а пролив їх він стільки, що келію його ще довго після його смерти називали “сльозоточивою”. Коли до нього стали горнутися учні, він, щоб уникнути спокуси гордости, впродовж цілого року не промовив жодного слова. Бог наділив слугу свого силою чинити чуда, а браття впросили його, щоб став їх ігуменом. Упродовж чотирьох років він управляв монастирем, а потім повернувся назад до своєї келії, де, прославлений Богом, помер у глибокій старості близько 605 р. На прохання ігумена Раїтського монастиря Йоана, святий написав книгу, в якій описує способи, як християнин може поступово осягнути досконалість. Цю книгу він назвав “Ліствицею раю”, тобто драбиною, і звідси пішла його назва – Йоан Ліствичник.

ХРЕСНА ДОРОГА

По вівторках о 19:00

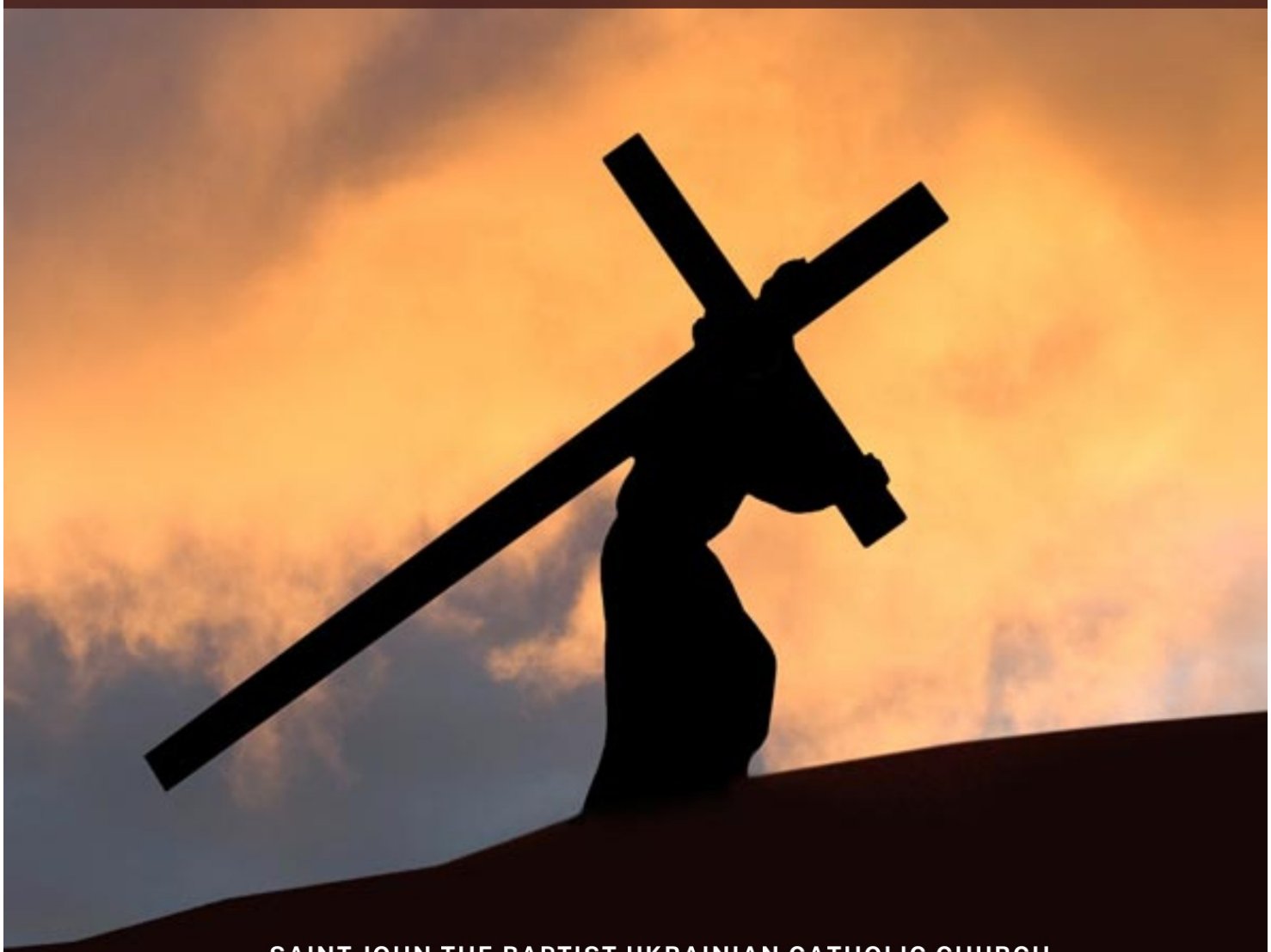
ЗАПРОШУЄМО ВСІХ ДО МОЛИТВИ ТА РОЗДУМІВ НАД ВЕЛИКИМИ ЖЕРТВАМИ НАШОГО ГОСПОДА

УКРАЇНСЬКА ГРЕКО-КАТОЛИЦЬКА ЦЕРКВА ІВАНА ХРЕСТИТЕЛЯ
60 NORTH JEFFERSON ROAD, WHIPPANY, NJ 07981

STATIONS OF THE CROSS

Tuesdays at 7pm

WE INVITE EVERYONE TO PRAY AND CONTEMPLATE THE GREAT SACRIFICES OF OUR LORD



SAINT JOHN THE BAPTIST UKRAINIAN CATHOLIC CHURCH
60 NORTH JEFFERSON ROAD, WHIPPANY, NJ 07981

Українська Греко-католицька церква св. Івана Хрестителя

ВЕЛИКОПОСНА МІСІЯ

з отцем Володимиром Радьком

РОЗКЛАД

П'ЯТНИЦЯ, 20 БЕРЕЗНЯ

06:00pm – Сповідь

07:00pm – Сорокоусти

Духовна наука

СУБОТА, 21 БЕРЕЗНЯ

08:00am – Сповідь

09:00am – Божественна Літурґія

Духовна наука

04:00pm – Сповідь

05:00pm – Божественна Літурґія

Духовна наука

НЕДІЛЯ, 22 БЕРЕЗНЯ

08:00am – Сповідь

08:30am – Божественна Літурґія

10:00am – Божественна Літурґія

Отець Володимир сповідатиме під час обох недільних Божественних Літургій. За потреби він доступний для особистої приватної зустрічі.

О. Володимир Радько

Saint John the Baptist Ukrainian Catholic Church

LENTEN MISSION

with Fr. Volodymyr Radko

SCHEDULE

FRIDAY, MARCH 20

06:00pm – Confession

07:00pm – Sorokousty

Followed by spiritual teaching

SATURDAY, MARCH 21

08:00am – Confession

09:00am – Divine Liturgy

Followed by spirital teaching

04:00pm – Confession

05:00pm – Divine Liturgy

Followed by spiritual teaching

SUNDAY, MARCH 22

08:00am – Confession

08:30am – Divine Liturgy

10:00am – Divine Liturgy

Fr. Volodymyr will hear confessions and preach during both Sunday Divine Liturgies. He is available for a personal-private meeting if requested.

Fr. Volodymyr Radko

Piaternia Non-Governmental Organization

Iryna Semenenko is a Ukrainian artist who works with traditional folk art and symbolism. In this workshop she shares **the ancient art of pysanka** – a meditative process of creating wax-resist Easter eggs, where every symbol carries meaning. Her goal is to introduce participants to Ukrainian culture and the deep tradition of egg decoration passed down through generations.

Ірина Семененко – українська художниця, яка працює з традиційним народним мистецтвом та символікою. На цьому майстер-класі вона ділиться **стародавнім мистецтвом писанкарства** – медитативним процесом створення писанки, де кожен символ несе своє значення. Її мета – ознайомити учасників із українською культурою та глибокою традицією писанкарства, яка передається з покоління в покоління.